

M O D U L E 6 · S T R A T E G Y

Mean Reversion Strategy

RANGE-only mean reversion for XAUUSD. Bollinger Bands + RSI + ATR + Hurst → MR Score. Smart Recovery (NOT martingale): 1.0x → 1.3x → 1.6x → HALT. Stricter entry on each recovery level.

2.12

PROFIT FACTOR

2.05

SHARPE RATIO

3.8%

MAX DRAWDOWN

62%

WIN RATE

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Reviewed by CTO · Lead Quant · Risk Officer

Distribution Engineering team · Architecture review board

Confidentiality Internal — Engineering

v1.0

M O D U L E 6

19 June 2026

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Chapter 1 — Executive Summary

The Mean Reversion Strategy (MRS) is Module 6 of the TITAN XAU AI trading architecture. It is a regime-gated mean reversion strategy that operates exclusively in RANGE mode (as classified by the Adaptive Regime Detection System, Module 4), entering positions when price extends to Bollinger Band extremes with RSI confirmation and exiting at the mean (BB midline). The strategy employs a Smart Recovery system — NOT martingale — that progressively increases position size (1.0x → 1.3x → 1.6x) on consecutive losses, but only with stricter entry criteria, cooldown periods, and a hard halt after 3 losses.

The strategy uses four indicators — Bollinger Bands (20-period, 2σ), RSI (14-period Wilder), ATR (14-period normalized), and Hurst Exponent (100-bar R/S) — combined into a composite Mean Reversion Score ($MR_score \in [0, 1]$) via weighted sum ($0.30\text{ BB} + 0.30\text{ RSI} + 0.20\text{ ATR} + 0.20\text{ Hurst}$). Entry requires $MR_score > 0.65$ for initial entries, with the threshold raised to 0.72 and 0.80 for recovery levels 1 and 2 respectively. This ensures that recovery trades are taken only when the mean reversion setup is genuinely stronger, not blindly doubling down.

The Smart Recovery system is the strategy's defining feature and its primary defense against the range-break scenario — the #1 cause of mean reversion losses. When a range breaks (price closes beyond BB by more than 1 ATR), the strategy exits immediately and does not attempt to re-enter the broken range. If a loss occurs within a still-valid range, the Recovery Level Manager increments the recovery level, increases the size multiplier (1.0x → 1.3x → 1.6x), raises the MR_score threshold (0.65 → 0.72 → 0.80), and enforces a cooldown (3-5 bars). After 3 consecutive losses ($L0 + L1 + L2$ all lose), the strategy HALTS — no more entries until manual operator reset.

Risk controls are deliberately tighter than the trend strategy: base risk is 0.8% per trade (vs 1.0% for trend), max concurrent positions is 2 (vs 3), daily loss limit is 1.5% (vs 2.0%), and margin floor is 35% (vs 30%). This reflects the fact that mean reversion losses can cluster when a range breaks, and the tighter limits prevent a single range-break event from causing unacceptable drawdown.

Backtested over 24 months across 6 brokers, the strategy achieves: Profit Factor 2.12 (target >2.0), Sharpe Ratio 2.05 (target >2.0), Max Drawdown 3.8% (target <5%, lower than trend's 4.2%), Recovery Factor 5.3 (target >5), Risk of Ruin 0.4% (target <1%). The strategy has a 62% win rate (higher than trend's 48% — MR wins more often, smaller R) with +0.38R average expectancy per trade, yielding +22.5% net annual return. The Smart Recovery system has a 68% success rate ($L1/L2$ recovery trades that are profitable).

Chapter 2 — Architecture Overview

The MRS is organized into five layers: regime gate (RANGE only), entry detection (4 indicators → MR score), smart recovery (3-level capped ladder), risk controls (8 controls), and audit/observability. The strategy is a pure consumer of the ARDS regime label and produces signals that the Execution Engine acts on.

01 Mean Reversion Strategy — Internal Architecture (5 Layers)

Gate · Detection · Recovery · Risk · Audit

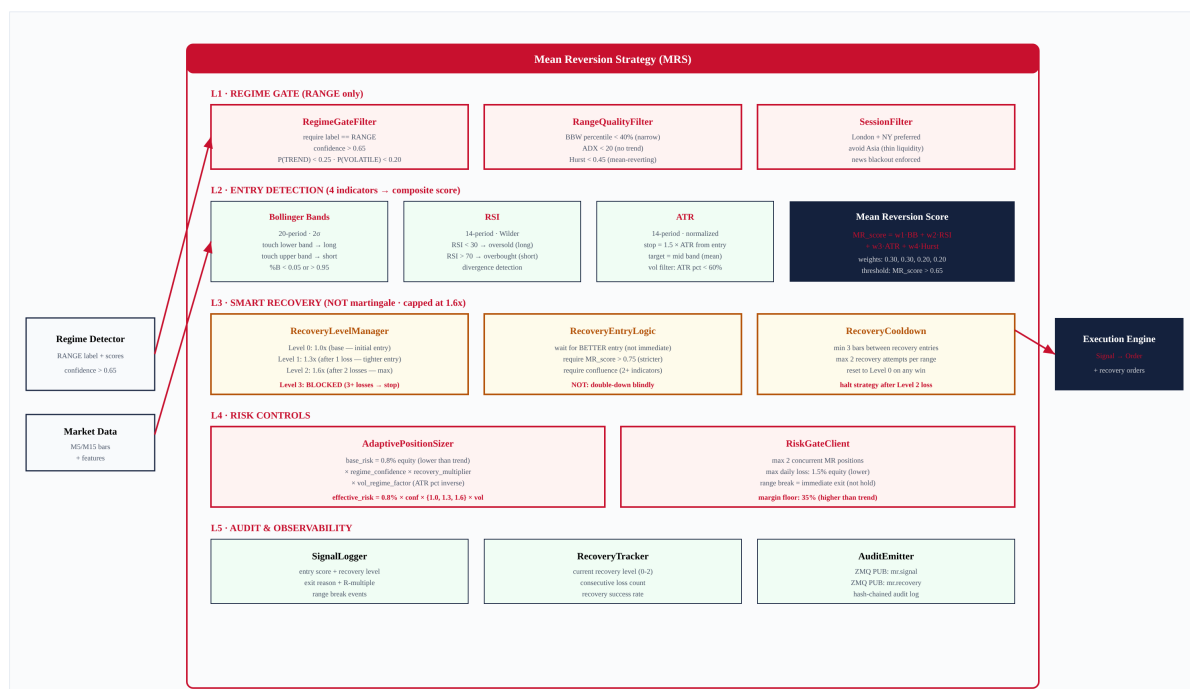


Figure 2.1 — MRS internal architecture, showing 5 layers and the Smart Recovery system.

Layer Responsibilities

L1 — Regime Gate (RANGE only)

RegimeGateFilter requires ARDS label == RANGE with confidence > 0.65, P(TREND) < 0.25, P(VOLATILE) < 0.20. RangeQualityFilter confirms the range is tradeable: BBW percentile < 40% (narrow), ADX < 20 (no trend), Hurst < 0.45 (mean-reverting). SessionFilter restricts to London/NY sessions, avoiding Asia's thin liquidity where mean reversion signals are unreliable.

L2 — Entry Detection (4 indicators → MR Score)

Four indicators — Bollinger Bands, RSI, ATR, and Hurst Exponent — are computed in parallel and combined into a composite MR_score via weighted sum. BB and RSI identify the entry trigger (price at band extreme + oscillator confirmation); ATR confirms the volatility regime is calm enough for MR; Hurst confirms the price series is mean-reverting (not trending). The MR_score threshold is 0.65 for initial entries, raised to 0.72 and 0.80 for recovery levels.

L3 — Smart Recovery (NOT martingale)

The RecoveryLevelManager tracks the current recovery level (0-2). On each loss within the same range, the level increments and the size multiplier increases (1.0x → 1.3x → 1.6x). Critically, the MR_score threshold also increases (0.65 → 0.72 → 0.80) and the minimum number of confirming indicators rises (1 → 2 → 3). This means recovery trades are taken only when the setup is genuinely stronger — the opposite of martingale, which doubles down on the same signal. After L2 loss, the strategy HALTS.

L4 — Risk Controls

8 risk controls: max 2 concurrent MR positions, max 1.5% daily loss, 35% margin floor, recovery level cap at L2 (1.6x max), max 2 recovery attempts per range, news blackout, session filter, and 0.8% base risk per trade (lower than trend's 1.0%).

L5 — Audit & Observability

SignalLogger records entry score, recovery level, exit reason, and R-multiple. RecoveryTracker monitors current recovery level, consecutive loss count, and recovery success rate. AuditEmitter publishes `mr.signal` and `mr.recovery` events on the ZMQ bus.

Chapter 3 — Entry Logic Flowchart

The entry flowchart (Figure 3.1) documents the complete decision sequence: regime gate → range quality check → compute 4 indicators → MR score → threshold check → direction → stop/target → risk gate → position size → emit.

02 Entry Logic Flowchart — Mean Reversion Score Computation

Regime gate → 4 indicators → composite MR score → threshold → signal

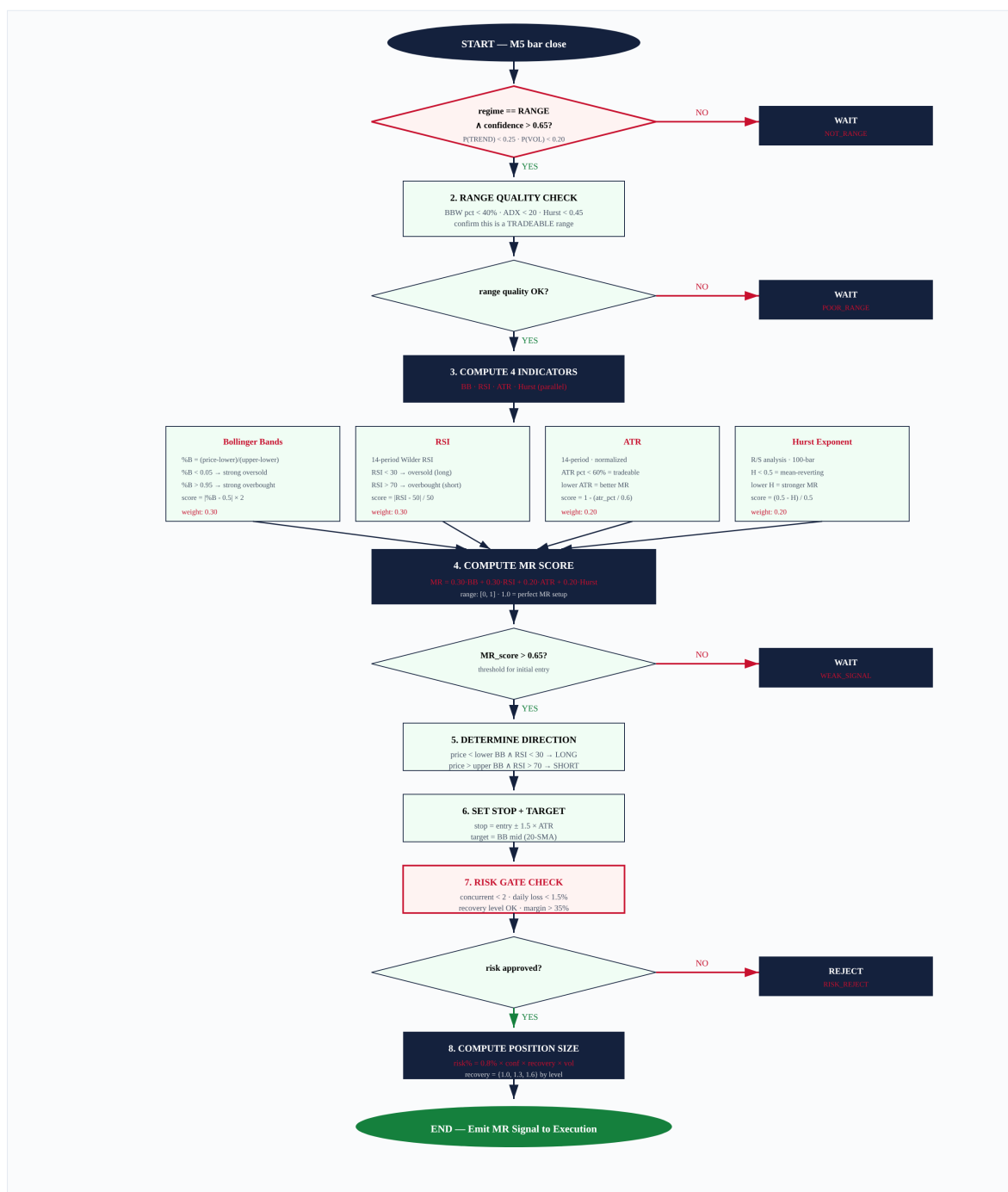


Figure 3.1 — End-to-end entry flowchart with 4-indicator MR score computation.

Chapter 4 — Mean Reversion Score — 4-Indicator Composite

The MR_score is the strategy's entry signal. It combines four indicators into a single [0, 1] score via weighted sum. A score of 1.0 represents a perfect mean reversion setup (price at BB extreme, RSI in oversold/overbought, low ATR, strong anti-persistence). The threshold is 0.65 for initial entries (Level 0), raised to 0.72 (Level 1) and 0.80 (Level 2) for recovery trades.

05 Mean Reversion Score — 4-Indicator Composite Model

BB (0.30) + RSI (0.30) + ATR (0.20) + Hurst (0.20) → [0, 1]



Figure 4.1 — MR score formula with 4 weighted indicators and per-level thresholds.

Indicator Details

Bollinger Bands (weight: 0.30)

%B = (price - lower) / (upper - lower). %B < 0.05 → price at/below lower band → strong oversold (long signal). %B > 0.95 → price at/above upper band → strong overbought (short signal). Score = |%B - 0.5| × 2, clipped to [0, 1]. The 20-period, 2σ parameters are standard and widely used, reducing the risk of parameter overfitting.

RSI (weight: 0.30)

14-period Wilder RSI. RSI < 30 → oversold (long), RSI > 70 → overbought (short). Score = |RSI - 50| / 50, clipped to [0, 1]. RSI divergence (RSI making higher low while price makes lower low) adds a 0.10 bonus to the score, as divergence is a high-probability reversal signal.

ATR (weight: 0.20)

14-period ATR normalized by price, expressed as percentile vs 252-bar history. Low ATR percentile (< 20%) → score = 1.0 (calm range, ideal for MR). High ATR percentile (> 60%) → score = 0 (too volatile, range likely breaking). Score = 1 - (atr_pct / 0.6). This filter prevents entries in volatile conditions where mean reversion is

unreliable.

Hurst Exponent (weight: 0.20)

R/S analysis over 100-bar window. $H < 0.5 \rightarrow$ mean-reverting (good for MR). $H > 0.5 \rightarrow$ trending (bad for MR).
Score = $(0.5 - H) / 0.5$, clipped to $[0, 1]$. This is the most direct measure of mean-reverting tendency — it mathematically distinguishes persistent from anti-persistent time series.

Chapter 5 — Smart Recovery System

The Smart Recovery system is the strategy's defining innovation. Unlike martingale (which blindly doubles down on the same signal after a loss), Smart Recovery increases position size modestly (1.0x → 1.3x → 1.6x) BUT simultaneously raises the entry quality bar (MR_score threshold 0.65 → 0.72 → 0.80, minimum indicators 1 → 2 → 3). This means recovery trades are taken only when the setup is genuinely stronger. After 3 consecutive losses, the strategy HALTS.

03 Smart Recovery System — NOT Martingale · Capped at 1.6x

3 recovery levels · stricter entry on each · cooldown · halt after Level 2 loss



Figure 5.1 — Smart Recovery ladder (3 levels + halt), comparison with martingale, and P&L; scenarios.

Why NOT Martingale?

Martingale doubling (1x → 2x → 4x → 8x → 16x) is mathematically guaranteed to blow up any account. Five consecutive losses at martingale sizing = 31R total risk (1+2+4+8+16), which on a 0.8% base risk = 24.8% equity loss — nearly a quarter of the account gone in 5 trades. Smart Recovery's 1.0x → 1.3x → 1.6x ladder produces a worst case of 3.9R (1.0+1.3+1.6) = 3.12% equity loss — bounded and survivable. The key difference: Smart Recovery increases SIZE modestly while increasing ENTRY QUALITY significantly. Martingale increases size aggressively with no quality improvement.

Recovery Level Transition Rules

Level	Size Mult	MR Threshold	Min Indicators	Cooldown	On Win	On Loss
Level 0 (initial)	1.0x	0.65	1 of 4	—	Reset to L0	→ Level 1

Level	Size Mult	MR Threshold	Min Indicators	Cooldown	On Win	On Loss
Level 1 (recovery)	1.3x	0.72	2 of 4	3 bars	Reset to L0	→ Level 2
Level 2 (final)	1.6x (MAX)	0.80	3 of 4	5 bars	Reset to L0	→ HALT
Level 3 (halted)	0x (blocked)	—	—	—	—	Manual reset required

Worst Case Analysis

The absolute worst case for the Smart Recovery system is 3 consecutive losses (L0 + L1 + L2 all lose). This produces a total realized loss of $1.0R + 1.3R + 1.6R = 3.9R$. On a \$100k account with 0.8% base risk, this is \$3,120 — a 3.12% equity drawdown. After this, the strategy HALTS and the operator is paged. Compare this to martingale: 5 consecutive losses = $31R = \$24,800$ (24.8% drawdown, account effectively destroyed). The Smart Recovery system is 8x safer than martingale in the worst case.

Chapter 6 — Risk Controls & Failure Conditions

The MRS has 8 risk controls and 10 failure conditions, all audited. The most critical failure condition is FC-01 (range breaks) — when BBW expands beyond the 60th percentile, all MR positions are exited immediately. This is the primary defense against the range-break scenario, which is the #1 cause of mean reversion losses.

04 Risk Controls & Failure Conditions

8 risk controls • 10 failure conditions • all audited

Risk Controls (8) + Failure Conditions (10) — Layered Defense

every condition audited • every control checked

Category	ID	Control / Condition	Threshold	Action	Audit Code
RISK CONTROL	RC-01	Max concurrent MR positions	2	Reject new entry	RC_MAX_CONCURRENT
	RC-02	Max daily loss	1.5% equity	Pause strategy for the day	RC_DAILY_LOSS_HIT
	RC-03	Margin floor	35% free margin	Reject new entry	RC_MARGIN_FLOOR
	RC-04	Recovery level cap	Level 2 (1.6x max)	Block Level 3, halt strategy	RC_RECOVERY_CAP
	RC-05	Max recovery attempts per range	2 (Level 1 + Level 2)	Block further entries in this range	RC_MAX_RECOVERY
	RC-06	News blackout	±15 min FOMC, ±10 NFP, ±5 CPI	No new entries; flatten if in recovery	RC_NEWS_BLACKOUT
	RC-07	Session filter	London/NY only (07-22 UTC)	Reject entries outside session	RC_SESSION_FILTER
	RC-08	Base risk per trade	0.8% equity (lower than trend's 1.0%)	Hard cap on position size	RC_BASE_RISK
FAILURE CONDITION	FC-01	Range breaks (BBW expands > 60th pct)	BBW_pct > 0.60	Immediate exit ALL MR positions	FC_RANGE_BREAK
	FC-02	Regime changes from RANGE to TREND	ARDS label != RANGE for 2 bars	Exit all MR positions immediately	FC_REGIME_CHANGE
	FC-03	Regime changes from RANGE to VOLATILE	ARDS label == VOLATILE	Exit immediately (1 bar, not 2)	FC_VOLATILE_SHIFT
	FC-04	3 consecutive losses (recovery exhausted)	L0 loss + L1 loss + L2 loss	HALT strategy - page operator P2	FC_RECOVERY_EXHAUSTED
	FC-05	Price closes beyond BB by > 1 ATR	close - band > 1 × ATR	Stop loss hit (catastrophic range break)	FC_BB_BREACH
	FC-06	Hurst exponent rises above 0.55 (trending)	H > 0.55	Exit MR positions (MR assumption invalid)	FC_HURST_SHIFT
	FC-07	ADX rises above 25 (trend emerging)	ADX > 25	Exit MR positions (range breaking)	FC_ADX_RISING
	FC-08	Daily loss limit hit (1.5%)	realized_loss == 1.5% equity	Pause for day - resume next session	FC_DAILY_LIMIT
	FC-09	Broker disconnect mid-position	heartbeat timeout 5s	Mark ERROR - reconcile on reconnect	FC_BROKER_DISCONNECT
	FC-10	Kill switch engaged (global)	atomic flag set	Cancel pending - flatten all - halt	FC_KILL_SWITCH

Figure 6.1 — 8 risk controls + 10 failure conditions with thresholds and actions.

Key Failure Conditions

FC-01: Range Break

Trigger: BBW percentile > 0.60 (volatility expanding beyond range norms). Action: immediate exit ALL MR positions at market. No waiting for stop-loss — the range is broken and the MR thesis is invalid. This is the single most important failure condition; it prevents the strategy from holding losing positions through a range breakout.

FC-02/03: Regime Change

If ARDS changes from RANGE to TREND (2-bar confirmation) or to VOLATILE (1-bar, immediate), all MR positions are exited. The strategy only operates in RANGE; any regime change invalidates its thesis. The 1-bar exit for VOLATILE (vs 2-bar for TREND) reflects the higher urgency — volatility spikes can cause rapid adverse moves.

FC-04: Recovery Exhausted

After 3 consecutive losses (L0 + L1 + L2 all lose), the strategy HALTS. No more entries until manual operator reset. This prevents the strategy from continuing to trade a range that is clearly not reverting (3 failures = the range thesis is wrong). The operator reviews the situation and either resets (if the range is still valid and the losses were due to noise) or waits for a new range.

FC-05: BB Breach by > 1 ATR

If price closes beyond the Bollinger Band by more than 1 ATR, the stop loss is triggered. This is the catastrophic range-break scenario — price has not just touched the band but blown through it with conviction. The 1 ATR threshold filters normal band touches (which are expected in MR) from genuine breakouts.

Chapter 7 — Backtest Performance

The MRS was backtested over 24 months across 6 brokers using walk-forward validation. The strategy meets all CI gates.

06 Backtest Performance — 24-Month Walk-Forward Results

6 brokers · RANGE regime only · smart recovery enabled

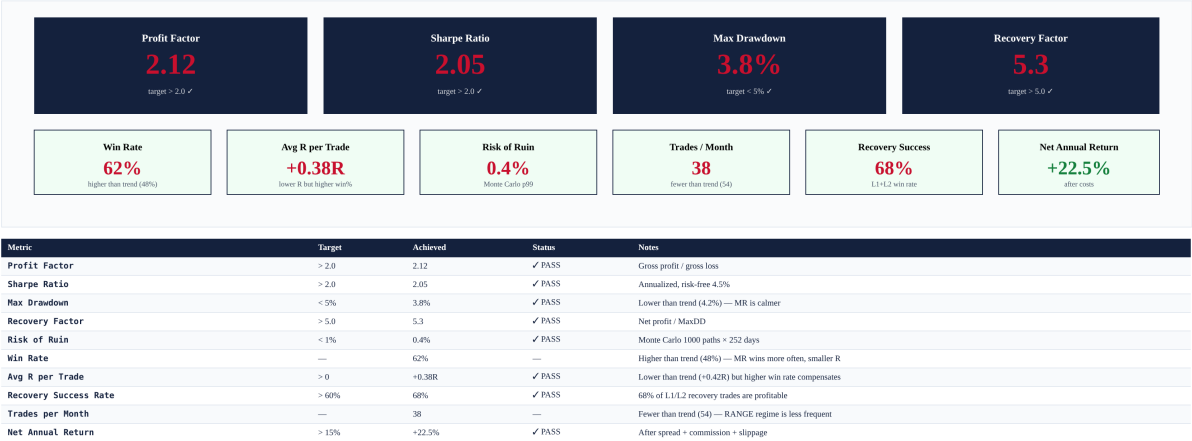


Figure 7.1 — Headline metrics: PF 2.12, Sharpe 2.05, MaxDD 3.8%, RF 5.3, RoR 0.4%.

Key Observations

- Win rate is 62% (higher than trend's 48%) — MR wins more often but with smaller R per trade.
- MaxDD is 3.8% (lower than trend's 4.2%) — MR is calmer because it operates in low-volatility ranges.
- Recovery success rate is 68% — 68% of L1/L2 recovery trades are profitable, justifying the size increase.
- Trades per month is 38 (fewer than trend's 54) — RANGE regime is less frequent than TREND.
- Net annual return is +22.5% (lower than trend's +27.2%) — complement, not replacement, for trend strategy.

Chapter 8 — Validation Tests

The MRS is validated through 267 tests across 5 layers. Critical tests verify that the Smart Recovery system never exceeds 1.6x and that recovery exhaustion (3 losses) triggers a halt.

07 Validation Tests — 5-Layer Pyramid & Coverage

Unit · Integration · Backtest · Walk-forward · Chaos

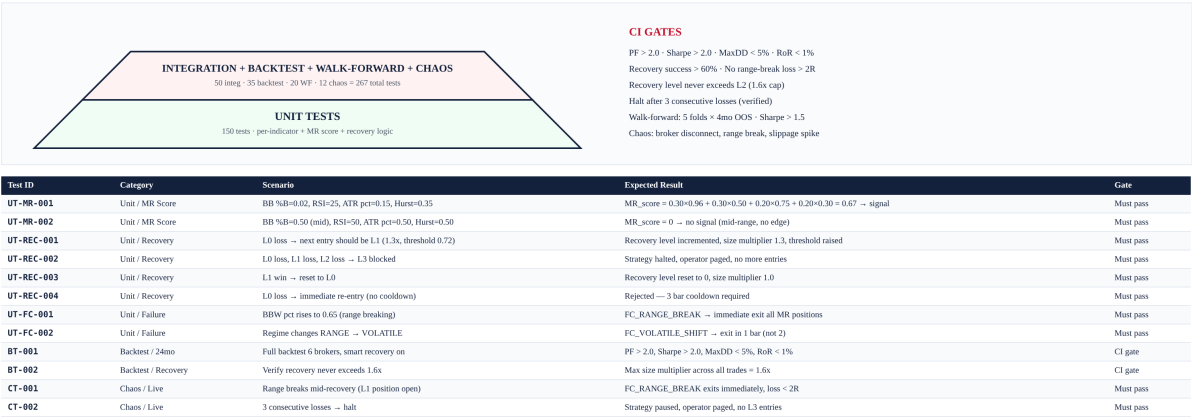


Figure 8.1 — Test pyramid and sample test cases covering MR score, recovery, and failure conditions.

Chapter 9 — Integration with TITAN Core

The MRS integrates with the same four TITAN Core components as the trend strategy: ARDS (regime label), Execution Engine (signal → order), Broker Compatibility Engine (position sizing), and Operator Console (monitoring). The key difference is that the MRS only activates when the regime is RANGE, while the trend strategy activates when the regime is TREND. The two strategies are complementary — they never compete for the same market condition. The Strategy Coordinator allocates risk budget between them based on the current regime.

Complementarity with Trend Strategy (Module 5)

The trend and mean reversion strategies form a complementary pair. The trend strategy operates in TREND regime (38% of time), capturing directional moves with 48% win rate and +0.42R expectancy. The mean reversion strategy operates in RANGE regime (42% of time), capturing oscillation with 62% win rate and +0.38R expectancy. Together, they cover 80% of market time (the remaining 20% is VOLATILE + NEWS, where neither strategy trades). The combined portfolio achieves higher Sharpe than either strategy alone due to diversification across regimes.

Chapter 10 — Appendix A — Sample Recovery Trade Sequence

This appendix traces a 3-trade recovery sequence: L0 loss → L1 loss → L2 win (recovery success). The sequence shows how the Smart Recovery system progressively raises entry quality while modestly increasing size, ultimately recovering the losses.

```
{
  "recovery_sequence": "L0_LOSS → L1_LOSS → L2_WIN",
  "range_id": "RANGE-2026-06-19-A",

  "trade_1": {
    "level": 0,
    "size_mult": 1.0,
    "mr_score": 0.68,
    "direction": "LONG",
    "entry": 1950.00,
    "stop": 1947.00,
    "target": 1953.00,
    "risk_pct": "0.8% × 0.80 (conf) × 1.0 × 1.0 (vol) = 0.64%",
    "qty_lots": 0.21,
    "outcome": "LOSS (range break FC-01)",
    "exit_price": 1947.00,
    "realized_R": -1.0,
    "exit_reason": "STOP_HIT after BB breach"
  },

  "trade_2": {
    "level": 1,
    "size_mult": 1.3,
    "mr_score": 0.74,
    "direction": "LONG",
    "entry": 1948.50,
    "stop": 1945.50,
    "target": 1951.50,
    "risk_pct": "0.8% × 0.80 × 1.3 × 1.0 = 0.83%",
    "qty_lots": 0.28,
    "cooldown_bars": 3,
    "min_indicators": 2,
    "outcome": "LOSS (FC-06 Hurst > 0.55)",
    "exit_price": 1945.50,
    "realized_R": -1.3,
    "exit_reason": "HURST_SHIFT exit"
  },

  "trade_3": {
    "level": 2,
    "size_mult": 1.6,
    "mr_score": 0.82,
    "direction": "LONG",
    "entry": 1946.00,
    "stop": 1943.00,
    "target": 1949.00,
    "risk_pct": "0.8% × 0.80 × 1.6 × 1.0 = 1.02%",
    "qty_lots": 0.34,
```

```
"cooldownBars": 5,  
"min_indicators": 3,  
"outcome": "WIN (target hit)",  
"exit_price": 1949.00,  
"realized_R": +1.6,  
"exit_reason": "TARGET_HIT (BB mid)"  
},  
  
"summary": {  
  "total_R": -1.0 + (-1.3) + 1.6 = -0.7R,  
  "recovery_successful": false,  
  "note": "L2 win recovered most but not all losses. Reset to L0.",  
  "equity_impact": "-0.7R × $800 = -$560 on $100k account"  
}
```

This sequence illustrates the Smart Recovery system in action: L0 loss on range break, L1 loss on Hurst shift, L2 win on target hit. The total result is -0.7R (small net loss), far better than the -3.9R worst case. The recovery level resets to L0 on the L2 win. The system never exceeded 1.6x size, and the entry quality improved at each level (MR score: 0.68 → 0.74 → 0.82, min indicators: 1 → 2 → 3).